# ONTARGET AFRICA

ISSUE 88

SPORTS-SHOOTING • TACTICAL • ELR • OPTICS • SAFETY • GEAR • HUNTING


## SA Gunowners' Association:
Overview of Firearm Control in Africa

## Send IT 22LR ELR:
The Juniors Make Us Proud!

## Send IT 2-Mile Challenge
Matroosberg

## EARMOR M23T AI Earbuds:
Field-tested by Aziza Scheidereiter, CHS Guns

## MDT DRT Chassis System
Lightweight Precision for the Field

## Havalon REDI
Fully Ambidextrous Folding Knife

## Acebeam L16 2.0 Tactical Flashlight
Beam Distance of up to 670 m

## First-Ever 2026 Western Province
Open .22LR F Class Championship

## Training, Fundamentals and Wind Reading:
LRSC Fun Shoot Skills Tests, Eendekuil

## Snake Season on W Cape Ranges:
A Guide by the Cape Reptile Institute


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# from the editor's desk

Can you believe that South Africa is not necessarily the most restrictive civilian-firearm regime in Africa? Other jurisdictions impose tighter access limits, annual renewal cycles, quotas or wider official discretion.

What distinguishes South Africa, however, is its combination of competency certification, purpose-based motivation, category-specific rules, a separate application for each firearm, recurring renewal, secure-storage requirements and unusually high administrative volume.

More paperwork does not, by itself, establish more effective control. The SA Gunowners' Association (SAGA) shares with *On Target Africa* what its assessment of selected African licensing systems can tell South Africa about risk and regulatory design.

Several firearm-related associations representing gun owners, many of which have highly experienced attorneys specialising in firearms law, are working daily to protect the rights of South African firearm owners and prospective new firearm owners. Much of this goes unseen and unnoticed by firearm owners. We salute them all and work alongside several of them. Where we can we publish their news and efforts in conjunction with their own media platforms.

We encourage firearm owners to join these associations. Find out what they do for you and join those most relevant to your needs. Keep their contact information readily available in several places so that you can access it when needed.

With more than 30 sports-shooting disciplines in South Africa, we have always placed a strong emphasis on reporting on and supporting the growth of juniors entering sports-shooting, as well as those learning about the safe handling of firearms at open days hosted by clubs, associations and shooting groups.

Over the years, the Send IT .22LR ELR group has hosted a dedicated platform and targets alongside its main matches. The junior sessions are well managed, with dedicated spotters, safety officers and the presence of mums and dads adding another layer of safety while the juniors enjoy the experience. Several of these juniors are already competing alongside adults in main matches, with ongoing safety supervision and instruction throughout the live shooting.

Helber Rifle Bullets and Ammunition is well known for supporting and sponsoring the South African National Schools Shooters Union (SANSSU), which includes competitive target shooting in Olympic-aligned disciplines such as air rifle, pistol, springer and sporter classes for school-aged youth.

The SANSSU SA Championship takes place from 26 September to 1 October in Bloemfontein, and the Helber team will be there. Visit https://sanssu.co.za/ for more information.

We are equally proud to report on firsts! **Rick Jaffe**, Chairman of the Western Province Bisley Association, writes about the first Western Province Open .22LR F Class Championship held on 12 September at the Good Hope Range in Atlantis. Congratulations to Paul van Gass on his inaugural Western Province .22LR F Class Championship win.

During 2020, several established print magazines closed. Others pivoted to becoming online-only publications, and firearms-sector publications were no different. As is typical in any industry, competitors are just that: competitors, particularly in the South African firearms media landscape, where publications compete for an ever-reducing share of media spend.

One publication covering some of the same categories as *On Target Africa* is the quarterly *Wingshooter* magazine, established in 1993. We have a mutual respect for each other's reporting. In Issue 88, *André van der Westhuizen*, ABC Lab Instructor for LRSC and SA Wingshooters and editor of *Wingshooter* online magazine, shares their report on the Long Range Shooting Club's (LRSC) event held on 5 September at Eendekuil, Piketberg. *Baie dankie, André.*

We also showcase several items in our popular Shooters' Gear. These pages are available to the firearms and firearms-accessory industry to submit items at a nominal cost.

As always, we welcome your feedback. Your input remains invaluable in shaping the direction and relevance of future editions of *On Target Africa*.

Please feel free to contact us at **editor@ontargetafrica.co.za**.

Warm regards

*Louise*

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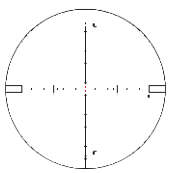

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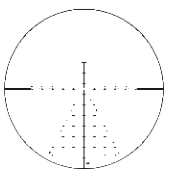

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# Send IT, ELR Shooting: Match Feedback

## By Charl Gous

**Dedicated to the development of Extreme Long Range (ELR) shooting, Send IT events cover various competitive match formats. Activities include the 1-Mile ELR Championship at Darling Steel Valley, .22LR ELR events at PEKS Shooting Range near Wellington, and the 2-Mile Challenge series at Matroosbergstasie near De Doorns. Send IT's flagship annual match is the Send IT ULTRA, shot at the Karoo King of the Plains Shooting Range near Hanover in the Northern Cape. The ULTRA was designed to test ELR shooters over a multi-day format at relatively predictable distances, being 800 m to 2.2 km, where the most consistent shooters rise to the top. Our annual program is designed to cultivate consistency and accuracy, exactly what is required to take on the ULTRA competitors that come from across South Africa, Namibia and internationally to compete.**

In this article we report back on two recent events, covering rimfire ELR action at the .22LR ELR match on 5 September and big bore performance at the 2-Mile Challenge on 23 May. We also look ahead, previewing the 2027 match schedule along with key updates and format changes planned for the upcoming season.

## Send IT, ELR Shooting, .22LR ELR Match: 5 September at PEKS Shooting Range

The course comprised three ranges with targets from 155 m to 423 m, fitted with electronic hit indicators to confirm successful impacts. All targets were 30 cm x 30 cm, apart from the cold bore targets at 10 cm x 10 cm. Each participant shot once at the cold bore target, followed by five shots at each target, with three standard targets per range, for a total 48 rounds for the match. To accommodate our junior shooters, we again set up a separate range with targets from 88 m to 268 m. The junior targets are smaller in size to make it more challenging to hit at closer distances.

**Send IT, ELR Shooting .22LR ELR**
**5 September 2026**
**.22LR ELR Event**

| *.22LR ELR Range* | | Range 1 | Range 2 | Range 3 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Cold Bore (m) | 155 | 188 | 166 |
| Target 1 | Distance (m) | 155 | 188 | 166 |
| Target 2 | Distance (m) | 261 | 343 | 265 |
| Target 3 | Distance (m) | 423 | 392 | 421 |

| *Junior Range* | | Range 1 | Range 2 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Target 1 | Distance (m) | 88 | 180 |
| Target 2 | Distance (m) | 120 | 236 |
| Target 3 | Distance (m) | 148 | 268 |

Leading up to match day, the Cape of Storms lived up to its name. Gale-force winds wreaked havoc, forcing Pieter Eksteen to rebuild the range on Friday before the competition could begin. By Saturday morning, a full-force 14 mph crosswind was howling at 07:00. As the day progressed, gusts exceeded 20 mph, leaving several shooters maxed out on windage adjustments.

Given these testing conditions, the scores were expected to be low compared to previous competitions. However, this was not the case, with several shooters managing to hit the far plates (over 392 m) with good consistency, while the top three's hit percentage was only marginally lower than the previous match with better weather.

▲ Riaan Kruger

▲ Arthur Kemp

▲ Andre Steenkamp

▲ Andrew Roseveare

▲ Bernard Eksteen

▲ Danie du Preez

▲ Deon Fabel

▲ Doemie Anderson

▲ Douw-Anton Hurter

▲ Franscois Gous

▲ Gerhard Slabbert

Top scores were extremely tight, with only 27 points separating second and third. A big congratulations to **Arthur Kemp** on claiming his maiden victory with four out of five hits on Target 3 (423 m) on Range 1, with 28 hits and 11 138 points.

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▲ Handré van Niekerk

▲ Handré van Niekerk

▲ Izak Hanekom

Runner-up **Deon Fabel** was in contention with 30 hits for 10 044 points, closely followed by newcomer **Riaan Kruger**, with 30 hits to secure third with 10 017 points. It is always fantastic to see a first-time competitor like Riaan show up, achieve a podium finish, and walk away hooked on ELR!

▲ Paul van Gass

▲ Jordan Terry

▲ Jordan Terry

▲ Marieke van Rooyen (shooter) Franscois Gous (spotter) and Arthur Kemp

▲ Kelly Hart-Davies

▲ Michael Meiring

▲ Marieke van Rooyen

▲ Charl Gous

▲ Tersia Kenny

▲ Tony Ingram

# Juniors

The competition was fierce on the junior range, where siblings and friends went head-to-head to secure Send IT medals. **Lea Kotze** delivered an impressive performance, dropping only three shots out of 30 to secure gold. **Ameli Brand** matched Lea in hits, but had to settle for silver, closely followed by little **Berrick (aka Bek) Kotze** with 26 hits for bronze. We are incredibly proud of the energy and skill these young shooters bring to the firing line and greatly enjoy their presence and the family affair these events have become. Well done, youngsters!

▲ Ameli Brand

▲ Berrick Kotze

▲ Riley Ingram

▲ Ameli Brand

▲ Berrick Kotze

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▲ Elmie du Preez

▲ Elmie du Preez

▲ Ferdinand du Preez

▲ Ferdinand du Preez

▲ Lea Kotze

▲ Lea Kotze

▲ Markus Jacobs

▲ Markus Jacobs

▲ Competitor Berrick Kotze and Spotter Lea Kotze

▲ Spotter Berrick Kotze and competitor Lea Kotze

**PEKS Shooting Range**
**5 September 2026**

**.22LR ELR Event**

| Rank | Name | Surname | TOTAL | Hits |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Arthur | Kemp | 11138 | 28 |
| 2 | Deon | Fabel | 10044 | 30 |
| 3 | Riaan | Kruger | 10017 | 30 |
| 4 | Izak | Hanekom | 9736 | 28 |
| 5 | Andrew | Roseveare | 9605 | 28 |
| 6 | Gerhard | Slabbert | 8686 | 26 |
| 7 | Andre | Steenkamp | 8656 | 27 |
| 8 | Pieter | Eksteen | 8546 | 27 |
| 9 | Kelly | Hart-Davies | 8541 | 27 |
| 10 | Paul | Van Gass | 8409 | 27 |
| 11 | Douw-Anton | Hurter | 8213 | 26 |
| 12 | Bernard | Eksteen | 8184 | 26 |
| 13 | Handré | van Niekerk | 7999 | 26 |
| 14 | Kobus | Swart | 7824 | 24 |
| 15 | Danie | du Preez | 7661 | 24 |
| 16 | Tony | Ingram | 7588 | 26 |
| 17 | Charl | Gous | 7132 | 24 |
| 18 | Doemie | Anderson | 7122 | 22 |
| 19 | Tersia | Kenny | 7001 | 23 |
| 20 | Michael | Meiring | 6944 | 23 |
| 21 | Jordan | Terry | 6283 | 21 |
| 22 | Franscois | Gous | 5910 | 20 |
| 23 | Jan | van Tonder | 5684 | 20 |
| 24 | Marieke | van Rooyen | 5102 | 17 |

▲ **Winners .22LR ELR Send IT of 5 September 2026**
L to R: Riaan Kruger, Arthur Kemp and Deon Fabel

**PEKS Shooting Range**
**5 September 2026**
**Juniors (younger than 13 years)**
**.22LR ELR Event**

| Rank | Name | Surname | TOTAL | Hits |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Lea | Kotze | 7099 | 27 |
| 2 | Ameli | Brand | 6516 | 27 |
| 3 | Berrick | Kotze | 6342 | 26 |
| 4 | Markus | Jacobs | 6239 | 24 |
| 5 | Elmie | du Preez | 6220 | 26 |
| 6 | Ferdinand | du Preez | 5640 | 22 |
| 7 | Riley | Ingram | 5377 | 24 |
| 8 | Nina | du Preez | 4329 | 20 |

▲ **Junior winners .22LR ELR Send IT of 5 September 2026**
L to R: Elmie du Preez, Ameli Brand, Riley Ingram, Markus Jacobs, Lea Kotze, Nina du Preez, Berrick Kotze and Ferdinand du Preez

# Send IT, ELR Shooting 2-Mile Challenge: 23 May (Qualifying Match 3 of 3) at Matroosbergstasie Shooting Range

Days of heavy rain leading up to the match left areas of the range wet and muddy. In these situations it is difficult to spot missed shots and call corrections for a shooter as there is very little feedback from the normally dusty environment. Match day shooting conditions was acceptable with a mild 4 mph to 8 mph wind oscillating between 6 o'clock and 8 o'clock that did just enough to push bullets left and right of the targets.

Below are the distances and hit percentages. These are remarkable results from a small group of dedicated ELR shooters who continue to support each other with superb camaraderie in a welcoming environment.

**Target 1 at 1 697 m (1 856 yd): 58% hit rate**

**Target 2 at 1 996 m (2 183 yd): 58% hit rate**

**Target 3 at 2 340 m (2 559 yd): 44% hit rate**

**Target 4 at 2 980 m (3 259 yd): 6% hit rate**

**Target 5 at 3 246 m (3 550 yd): 10% hit rate**

**Send IT, ELR Shooting 2-Mile Challenge | Matroosbergstasieskietklub | 23 May 2026**

| Target Number | Cold Bore | Target 1 | Target 2 | Target 3 | Target 4 | Target 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Distance (in metres) | 1696 | 1697 | 1996 | 2145 | 2340 | 3246 |
| Distance (in yards) | 1855 | 1856 | 2183 | 2346 | 2559 | 3550 |
| Target Size, cm (H & W) | 50 | 80 | 100 | 100 | 110 | 165 |
| Target Size, MOA (H & W) | 1.01 | 1.62 | 1.72 | 1.60 | 1.62 | 1.75 |

**Charl Gous**, deploying his trusted 375 ST (SnipeTac), made 16 hits, including two impacts on the 2-Mile target, to take home gold. Second was **Pieter Eksteen**, using a 375 CT, made 13 successful shots, including a second-shot impact at 2-miles.

Series leader **Ivan Fourie** (375 CT) achieved 12 hits but had to settle for bronze. Additional highlights included the cold bore target, measuring 50 cm x 50 cm or 1 MOA, set at 1 696 m (1855 yd), hit by Ivan Fourie and a hit Peter Kenmuir on the 2-mile target with a 33 XC!

**Send IT, ELR Shooting 2-Mile Challenge | Matroosbergstasieskietklub | 23 May 2026**

| Target Number | | | CB 1 | Target 1 | | | | | Target 2 | | | | | Target 3 | | | | | Target 4 | | | | | Target 5 | | | | | Total Nr. of HITS | TOTAL SCORE | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Distance (in metres) | | | 1696 | 1697 | | | | | 1996 | | | | | 2340 | | | | | 2980 | | | | | 3246 | | | | | | | |
| Distance (in yards) | | | 1855 | 1856 | | | | | 2183 | | | | | 2559 | | | | | 3259 | | | | | 3550 | | | | | | | |
| Target Size, cm (H & W) | | | 50 | 80 | 80 | 80 | 80 | 80 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 100 | 110 | 110 | 110 | 110 | 110 | 150 | 150 | 150 | 150 | 150 | 165 | 165 | 165 | 165 | 165 | | | |
| Target Size, MOA (H & W) | | | 1.01 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.72 | 1.72 | 1.72 | 1.72 | 1.72 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.62 | 1.73 | 1.73 | 1.73 | 1.73 | 1.73 | 1.75 | 1.75 | 1.75 | 1.75 | 1.75 | | | |
| Multiplier x distance (m) | | | 1.50 | 2.00 | 1.75 | 1.50 | 1.25 | 1.00 | 2.00 | 1.75 | 1.50 | 1.25 | 1.00 | 2.00 | 1.75 | 1.50 | 1.25 | 1.00 | 2.00 | 1.75 | 1.50 | 1.25 | 1.00 | 2.00 | 1.75 | 1.50 | 1.25 | 1.00 | | | |
| Nr | Name & Surname | Caliber | CB 1 | 1A | 1B | 1C | 1D | 1E | 1A | 1B | 1C | 1D | 1E | 1A | 1B | 1C | 1D | 1E | 1A | 1B | 1C | 1D | 1E | 1A | 1B | 1C | 1D | 1E | | | |
| 1 | Charl Gous | 375 ST | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 16 | 51,546 | Heavy Gun |
| 2 | Pieter Eksteen | 375 CT | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 13 | 42,716 | Heavy Gun |
| 3 | Ivan Fourie | 375 CT | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 12 | 36,040 | Heavy Gun |
| 4 | Deon Fabel | 37XC | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 10 | 31,483 | Heavy Gun |
| 5 | Warwick du Preez | 375 CT | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 10 | 30,172 | Heavy Gun |
| 6 | Giancarlo Ferrone | 375 CT | 0 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 6 | 17,905 | Heavy Gun |
| 7 | Danie du Preez | 416 Hellfire | 0 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 6 | 17,430 | Heavy Gun |
| 8 | Rigardt Botha | 375 CT | 0 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 6 | 17,208 | Heavy Gun |
| 9 | Peter Kenmuir | 33 XC | 0 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 5 | 14,888 | Light Gun |
| 10 | Edgar Doubell | 375 CT | 0 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 5 | 12,651 | Heavy Gun |

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Brass - Peterson Cartridge 6 GT
Bullet - 107 gr. Sierra Matchking
Powder - 33.2 gr. Varget®
Primer - CCI 450
Average Velocity - 889.6 meters per second
Dies - Hornady FL sizing die
Lube - Sinclair Sizing Wax
Resizing - Every Firing
Cleaning - No
Anneal - No

see the test:

▲ L to R: Charl Gous, Pieter Eksteen and Ivan Fourie

## Table A

2-Mile Challenge Hit History

Number of impacts achieved at 2-Miles

| | | 18/03/2023 | 20/05/2023 | 29/07/2023 | 20/01/2024 | 16/03/2024 | 13/04/2024 | 25/04/2024 | 16/11/2024 | 18/01/2025 | 15/03/2025 | 12/04/2025 | 24/05/2025 | 15/11/2025 | 14/03/2026 | 11/04/2026 | 23/05/2026 | TOTAL |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Andre Hanekom | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 | | | 1 |
| 2 | Bernard Eksteen | | | | | | | | 2 | | | | | | | | | 2 |
| 3 | Bernard Kotze | 1 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 |
| 4 | Charl Gous | 3 | | | | | | | | 1 | 3 | | | | | | 2 | 9 |
| 5 | Constantine Semka | | | | | | | 1 | | | | | | | | | | 1 |
| 6 | Danie du Preez | | | | | 1 | | | | | 1 | | | | | 1 | | 3 |
| 7 | Danie Koch | | | | | | | | | | | 2 | | | | | | 2 |
| 8 | Deon Fabel | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 | 1 | 1 | | 3 |
| 9 | Dwayne Cronje | | | | | 1 | | | 2 | | | | | | | | | 3 |
| 10 | Edgar Doubell | | | | | | 3 | | | | | | | | | | | 3 |
| 11 | Ivan Fourie | | | | 2 | 1 | | | | | | | | | 1 | 2 | | 6 |
| 12 | Izak Hanekom | | 1 | | | | | | | 1 | 2 | | | | 1 | | | 5 |
| 13 | James Preyser | | 1 | | | 1 | | 1 | 1 | | | | | | | | | 4 |
| 14 | JD Els | | | | | | | | | | | 1 | | | | | | 1 |
| 15 | John Justus | | 1 | | 1 | | | | | | | | | | | | | 2 |
| 16 | Karl van Eck | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 | | | 1 |
| 17 | Loutjie Hankom | | | | | 1 | | | | 2 | 1 | | | 1 | | | | 5 |
| 18 | Michael Hitchcock | | 1 | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 |
| 19 | Peter Kenmuir | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 | 1 |
| 20 | Pieter Eksteen | | | | | | | 1 | | 3 | 1 | | | | 1 | | 1 | 7 |
| 21 | Pieter Meyer | | | | | | | | | | | | 2 | | | | | 2 |
| 22 | Riaan Ludik | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 2 | | | 2 |
| 23 | Rigardt Botha | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 1 | 1 |
| 24 | Tony Ingram | | | | | | | | | | 1 | | | | 2 | 1 | | 4 |
| 25 | Warwick du Preez | | | | | | | | 1 | | 2 | | | | | | | 3 |
| | | **4** | **4** | **0** | **3** | **5** | **3** | **3** | **6** | **7** | **11** | **3** | **2** | **2** | **10** | **5** | **5** | **73** |
| | Hit % at 2-Miles | 7% | 4% | 0% | 4% | 6% | 3% | 4% | 8% | 16% | 14% | 5% | 3% | 4% | 12% | 8% | 10% | 6.1% |
| | **Number of shooters** | **12** | **20** | **22** | **16** | **16** | **22** | **14** | **15** | **9** | **16** | **12** | **14** | **10** | **17** | **13** | **10** | |

The 23 May 2-Mile Challenge produced five 2-mile impacts, and the data can now be added to the already impressive list of hits since 2023. Table A on the previous page is the record of all 2-Mile impacts at Send IT competitions, and hits by each shooter at a particular match.

From the data we can make interesting observations based on the 16 matches to date. Twenty-five shooters have made impact at 2-Miles, representing the lion's share of shooters who have attended Send IT 2-Mile competitions. Three shooters (**Charl Gous**, **Edgar Doubell** and **Pieter Eskateen**) have hit the target with three of their allowed five shots, and several shooters made two hits in a match. Since its inception, the 2-Mile target has been hit 73 times for an average hit rate of 6.1%.

Lastly, we thank the people who put in the demanding work to prepare our ranges and promote sports-shooting. We thank **Pieter Eksteen** (PEKS Shooting Range) and **Estian du Preez** (Matroosbergstasie Shooting Range) for their labours and for availing your facilities for all to enjoy.

# 2027 Dates and Planning

**We have exciting updates to share about where our matches are heading in the year ahead, how the leaderboards will be determined and the introduction of a "light class" at Send IT 2-Mile Challenges in 2027.**

We are moving away from the single 'finale' format at both the 1-Mile and 2-Mile series. Starting next year, an individual or team's (where applicable) year-to-date ranking will be determined by their top two match scores of the season. This gives everyone more flexibility across the calendar, while allowing us to condense the schedule from four to three matches per format.

Nothwithstanding the reduced number of matches, shooters will have more trigger time next season. At the 2-Mile Challenge, the round count will increase to 36 shots (from the current 26), comprising one shot at a cold-bore target and seven targets with five shots each.

In addition, a 'light' class will be introduced at the Send IT 2-Mile Challenge. 'Light' class shooters can now compete in both the 1-Mile Championship at Darling Steel Valley and the 2-Mile events at Matroosbergstasie. That gives 'light' class competitors six Send IT match opportunities a year compared to four in 2026.

The 'light' class will be restricted to 33 XC or smaller calibres, the range will be set from 1 000 m to roughly 2 000 m, will be shot under the same rule set of the 2-Mile Challenge, and also have a round count of 36 as unpacked above.

The formats for our flagship Send IT ULTRA and .22LR ELR matches will remain unchanged.

**Send IT, ELR Shooting - event dates 2027**

| Date | Format & Venue |
|---|---|
| 6 February | *1-Mile Challenge Q1* Darling Steel Valley |
| 6 March | PEKS Range *.22LR ELR* Wellington |
| 13 March | *2-Mile Challenge Q1* Matroosbergstasie Skietklub |
| 3 April | *1-Mile Challenge Q2* Darling Steel Valley |
| 10 April | *2-Mile Challenge Q2* Matroosbergstasie Skietklub |
| 29 April – 1 May | *Send IT* ULTRA Hanover, Northern Cape |
| 4 September | PEKS Range *.22LR ELR* Wellington |
| 30 October | *1-Mile Challenge FINAL* Darling Steel Valley |
| 13 November | *2-Mile Challenge* FINAL Matroosbergstasie Skietklub |

## *Until next time... get ready to... Send IT*

Anyone in need of additional information can contact Charl Gous on 083 4696 181. Be sure to follow Send IT, ELR Shooting on Facebook and send us a message to join the Send IT Telegram and or WhatsApp groups where all communications are posted.

Facebook:
https://www.facebook.com/Senditelrshooting/

Rules, event dates and results history:
https://senditelr.co.za/

Email:
senditelrshooting@gmail.com

▲ L to R: Pieter Eksteen, Martin Le Roux and Charl Gous

▲ L to R: Wayne Britts, Michael Duckitt and Johan Zulch

# Send IT, ELR Shooting: Darling Steel Valley

## By Charl Gous

**Another fantastic Send IT, ELR Shooting match hosted by Schalk Jacobs of Axis Precision Worx and Bernard Kotze from 3%Tactical on 19 September at Darling Steel Valley. Thank you for all your effort in ensuring another very enjoyable and safe event!**

Well done to Martin Le Roux with his maiden Send IT 1-Mile Championship individual win in difficult conditions. In addition, find the year-to-date 2026 1-Mile Championship rankings for individuals, teams as well as the 'light' class. All will be on the line at the series finale on 31 October… be prepared!

**SEND IT, ELR Shooting**
Date 19 September 2026
Venue Darling Steel Valley

1 MILE ELR Championship 2026

| Target 1 A | Target 2 A | Target 3 A | Target 4 A |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1150 m | 994 m | 991 m | 1026 m |
| Target 1 B | Target 2 B | Target 3 B | Target 4 B |
| 1258 m | 1395 m | 1428 m | 1541 m |
| Target 1 C | Target 2 C | Target 3 C | Target 4 C |
| 1349 m | 1539 m | 1560 m | 1692 m |
| Target 1 D | Target 2 D | Target 3 D | Target 4 D |
| 1473 m | 1651 m | 1857 m | 1754 m |

Thanks to the new shooters who joined us and to Hendrie Brink for availing his facilities available for all to enjoy. Another great day to remember! Next up we head to Parys, Free State, where on 17 October teams of 12 shooters from the North and South will battle it out in the annual regional ELR challenge.

RANKED LIGHT

**SEND IT, ELR Shooting**
Date 19 September 2026
Venue Darling Steel Valley
1 MILE ELR Championship 2026

Distance in meter

| | | | | Range 1 | | | | | | | Range 2 | | | | | | | Range 3 | | | | | | | Range 4 | | | | | | | TOTAL SCORE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | 1A | | 1B | | 1C | | | 2A | | 2B | | 2C | | | 3A | | 3B | | 3C | | | 4A | | 4B | | 4C | | | |
| | | | | 1258 | | 1349 | | 1473 | | | 1395 | | 1539 | | 1651 | | | 1428 | | 1560 | | 1857 | | | 1541 | | 1692 | | 1754 | | | |
| Nr. | Shooter | Team | Caliber | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | |
| 1 | Michael Duckitt (L) | Team Darling (L) | 6,5X55AI | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 24,700 |
| 2 | Johan Zulch (L) | Tarentale | RSAUM | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 21,798 |
| 3 | Wayne Britts (L) | Team Darling (L) | 7RSAUM | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 14,316 |
| 4 | Charles du Plessis Snr (L) | Overwatch (L) | 6,5 PRC | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | | 12,190 |
| 5 | Charles du Plessis Jnr (L) | Overwatch (L) | 260 REM AI | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | | 6,479 |

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**SEND IT, ELR Shooting**
Date 19 September 2026
Venue Darling Steel Valley

1 MILE ELR Championship 2026

RANKED HEAVY

| Nr. | Shooter | Team | Caliber | Range 1 | | | | | | | Range 2 | | | | | | | Range 3 | | | | | | | Range 4 | | | | | | | TOTAL SCORE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | 1A | | 1B | | 1C | | | 2A | | 2B | | 2C | | | 3A | | 3B | | 3C | | | 4A | | 4B | | 4C | | | |
| | | | Distance in meter | 1258 | | 1349 | | 1473 | | | 1395 | | 1539 | | 1651 | | | 1428 | | 1560 | | 1857 | | | 1541 | | 1692 | | 1754 | | | |
| | | | | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S1 | S2 | S3 | |
| 1 | Martin Le Roux | JSN | 300 NMI | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 37,196 |
| 2 | Pieter Eksteen | Weekend Warriors | 33XC | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 35,899 |
| 3 | Charl Gous | Boetas | 33XC | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 35,483 |
| 4 | Danie Du Preez | Avo | 300 NMI | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 34,371 |
| 5 | Schalk Jacobs | Bad Company | 33XC | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 34,042 |
| 6 | Louis Van Zyl | H208 | 300 PRC | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 34,006 |
| 7 | Loutjie Hanekom | Wind se skuld | 338 LM AI | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 33,501 |
| 8 | Mario Snyman | ZipCode | 300PRC | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 31,886 |
| 9 | Tiaan Vermeulen | Voltage Relay | 338 LM | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | 31,784 |
| 10 | Brendan Speck | 338 Impact | 338 LM AI | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 31,296 |
| 11 | Twakkies Goosen | Gooi Lood | 33XC | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 30,913 |
| 12 | James Preyser | Bomb Squad | 33XC | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 30,719 |
| 13 | Pieter Swart | ZipCode | 338 LM | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 30,127 |
| 14 | Michael Hitchcock | Boetas | 338 LM AI | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 29,522 |
| 15 | Jan Rabie | ICBM | 300WM | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 28,964 |
| 16 | Ivan Fourie | Bomb Squad | 33XC | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 28,727 |
| 17 | Heinrich Stoltz | Mior Mor | 300 WM | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 28,454 |
| 18 | Bernard Kotze | Bad Company | 338LM AI | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 27,053 |
| 19 | Duncan De Beer | Only Guns | 33XC | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 26,723 |
| 20 | Andre Hanekom | Wind se skuld | 338 LM AI | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 25,948 |
| 21 | Pierre Du Tiot | Gooi Lood | 33XC | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 24,323 |
| 22 | Deon Fabel | Weekend Warriors | 33XC | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 22,257 |
| 23 | Wayne Bird | ICBM | 300NMI | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 21,597 |
| 24 | Dean McKelvey | Mior Mor | 300 PRC | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | 20,988 |
| 25 | Phillip Potgieter | Kakskiet | 300 PRC | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 20,393 |
| 26 | Hendrie Brink | Team Hornady | 338 LM | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 19,808 |
| 27 | DJ Van Zyl | Avo | 300 NMI | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 18,721 |
| 28 | JB Erasmus | Tarentale | 338 LM AI | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 17,931 |
| 29 | Peter Kenmuir | 338 Impact | 33XC | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 15,822 |
| 30 | Theuns Buys | Voltage Relay | 338 LM | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | 15,810 |
| 31 | Kayla Brink | Team Hornady | 300PRC | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 13,481 |
| 32 | Giancarlo Ferrone | Kakskiet | 338 LM AI | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 12,965 |
| 33 | PJ Cilliers | Only Guns | 300PRC | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | - | - | - | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | 12,425 |
| 34 | Riaan Ludik | JSN | 338 LM | - | - | - | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | 1 | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | - | 11,871 |

## Individual Results:

| Nr. | Shooter | Team name | TOTAL | Hit % |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Martin Le Roux | JSN | 37,196.3 | 68% |
| 2 | Pieter Eksteen | Weekend Warriors | 35,898.5 | 68% |
| 3 | Charl Gous | Boetas | 35,482.5 | 68% |
| 4 | Danie Du Preez | Avo | 34,371.0 | 64% |
| 5 | Schalk Jacobs | Bad Company | 34,041.8 | 64% |
| 6 | Louis Van Zyl | H208 | 34,005.8 | 61% |
| 7 | Loutjie Hanekom | Wind se skuld | 33,500.5 | 64% |
| 8 | Mario Snyman | ZipCode | 31,886.0 | 61% |
| 9 | Tiaan Vermeulen | Voltage Relay | 31,784.3 | 61% |
| 10 | Brendan Speck | 338 Impact | 31,296.0 | 61% |
| 11 | Twakkies Goosen | Gooi Lood | 30,912.8 | 61% |
| 12 | James Preyser | Bomb Squad | 30,718.5 | 57% |
| 13 | Pieter Swart | ZipCode | 30,126.5 | 57% |
| 14 | Michael Hitchcock | Boetas | 29,521.8 | 57% |
| 15 | Jan Rabie | ICBM | 28,964.0 | 54% |
| 16 | Ivan Fourie | Bomb Squad | 28,726.8 | 57% |
| 17 | Heinrich Stoltz | Mior Mor | 28,454.3 | 54% |
| 18 | Bernard Kotze | Bad Company | 27,052.5 | 54% |
| 19 | Duncan De Beer | Only Guns | 26,722.8 | 50% |
| 20 | Andre Hanekom | Wind se skuld | 25,948.3 | 50% |
| 21 | Michael Duckitt (L) | Team Darling (L) | 24,699.5 | 57% |
| 22 | Pierre Du Tiot | Gooi Lood | 24,323.3 | 50% |
| 23 | Deon Fabel | Weekend Warriors | 22,257.3 | 46% |
| 24 | Johan Zulch (L) | Tarentale | 21,798.0 | 46% |
| 25 | Wayne Bird | ICBM | 21,596.5 | 43% |
| 26 | Dean McKelvey | Mior Mor | 20,987.8 | 39% |
| 27 | Phillip Potgieter | Kakskiet | 20,392.8 | 36% |
| 28 | Hendrie Brink | Team Hornady | 19,807.8 | 36% |
| 29 | DJ Van Zyl | Avo | 18,721.0 | 36% |
| 30 | JB Erasmus | Tarentale | 17,931.0 | 32% |
| 31 | Peter Kenmuir | 338 Impact | 15,822 | 32% |
| 32 | Theuns Buys | Voltage Relay | 15,810 | 29% |
| 33 | Wayne Britts (L) | Team Darling (L) | 14,316 | 36% |
| 34 | Kayla Brink | Team Hornady | 13,481 | 29% |
| 35 | Giancarlo Ferrone | Kakskiet | 12,965 | 25% |
| 36 | PJ Cilliers | Only Guns | 12,425 | 25% |
| 37 | Charles du Plessis Snr (L) | Overwatch (L) | 12,190 | 25% |
| 38 | Riaan Ludik | JSN | 11,871 | 25% |
| 39 | Charles du Plessis Jnr (L) | Overwatch (L) | 6,479 | 14% |

## Team Results:

| Nr. | Team | TOTAL | Hit % |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nr. | Team | TOTAL | Hit % |
| 1 | Boetas | 65,004.3 | 63% |
| 2 | ZipCode | 62,012.5 | 59% |
| 3 | Bad Company | 61,094.3 | 59% |
| 4 | Wind se skuld | 59,448.8 | 57% |
| 5 | Bomb Squad | 59,445.3 | 57% |
| 6 | Weekend Warriors | 58,155.8 | 57% |
| 7 | Gooi Lood | 55,236.0 | 55% |
| 8 | Avo | 53,092.0 | 50% |
| 9 | ICBM | 50,560.5 | 48% |
| 10 | Mior Mor | 49,442.0 | 46% |
| 11 | JSN | 49,066.8 | 46% |
| 12 | Voltage Relay | 47,594.5 | 45% |
| 13 | 338 Impact | 47,118.3 | 46% |
| 14 | Tarentale | 39,729.0 | 39% |
| 15 | Only Guns | 39,147.3 | 38% |
| 16 | Team Darling (L) | 39,015.8 | 46% |
| 17 | H208 | 34,006 | 30% |
| 18 | Kakskiet | 33,358 | 30% |
| 19 | Team Hornady | 33,288 | 32% |
| 20 | Overwatch (L) | 18,669 | 20% |

**SEND IT, ELR Shooting**
Date 19 September 2026
Venue Darling Steel Valley

## *Until next time... get ready to... Send IT*

Anyone in need of additional information can contact Charl Gous on 083 4696 181. Be sure to follow Send IT, ELR Shooting on Facebook and send us a message to join the Send IT Telegram and or WhatsApp groups where all communications are posted.

Facebook:
https://www.facebook.com/Senditelrshooting/

Rules, event dates and results history:
https://senditelr.co.za/

Email:
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# First-Ever 2026 Western Province Open .22LR F Class Championship

By Rick Jaffe

Rick Jaffe

The first-ever Western Province .22LR F Class Championship was held on 12 September on a wet and windy day at the Good Hope Military Range near Atlantis.

Wind flag at 11h33, 12 September 2026

There was considerable interest in the inaugural event, with shooters travelling from as far afield as George. Several experienced .22 PRS and .22 ELR competitors also attended, adding considerable depth to the field as they competed for the title of Western Province .22LR F Class Champion.

The competition was shot over four distances, with a Short-Range Medal awarded for the highest aggregate score over ten shots at 100 m and 15 shots at 150 m, as well as a Long-Range Medal up for grabs with ten shots at 200 m and 15 shots at 300 m.

## Setting the standard

The start was slightly delayed due to inclement weather, but shooting soon got underway at 100 m. **Carel Taljaard**, a former F-Open national team member, immediately set the standard by shooting a perfect 50 with an impressive 9 V-Bulls.

Close behind him was Paul Van Gass with 50.5, while several other competitors recorded scores of 49 and 48 with high V-Bull counts.

In .22LR F Class, the scoring ring sizes are approximately:

| Score | Ring Size |
|---|---|
| V Bull | 1 MOA |
| 5 | 2 MOA |
| 4 | 4 MOA |
| 3 | 6 MOA |

It rained on and off for most of the day, with the wind steadily increasing in strength as the competition progressed. There were two details of shooters, with three competitors per target at each distance, lying shoulder-to-shoulder and shooting one after another.

With each person having 45 seconds to make their shot, the gap between shots for each individual competitor was 90 seconds. Therefore, wind direction and speed could change significantly from shot to shot, resulting in close attention needing to be paid to the conditions immediately before each shot.

◂ Paul Van Gass

▲ Francois De Villiers

▲ Jaco Steyn

▲ Rick Jaffe

▲ Marieke Van Rooyen

▲ Peru Van Staden

▲ Sakkie Rust

## Demonstrable experience

At 150 m, competitors fired 15 shots. **Francois De Villiers** demonstrated his experience as both an F-TR competitor and a top .22LR F-Class shooter, recording a perfect 75 with 6 V-Bulls.

Both **Carel Taljaard** and **Paul Van Gass** dropped only one point at this distance.

The competitors then moved back to 200 m for ten shots, with the wind continuing to strengthen. Paul once again showed his class, recording the top score of 50.6. Several competitors were able to record scores of 49, accompanied by good V-Bull counts.

▶ Peru van Staden and Rick Jaffe

▲ Johan Dippenaar

▲ L to R: Francois De Villiers, Paul van Gass (middle) and Francois Vogel

▲ Francois Vogel

▲ Ian Noble-Jack

▲ Marcel Viljoen

The final distance of the day was 300 m, with winds gusting up to 18 mph. This required more than 50 MOA of elevation and approximately 15 MOA of windage. At this point, the leading five shooters were separated by only four points and a few V-Bulls. Paul and Carel once again demonstrated their ability to read the difficult conditions, recording scores of 70.2 and 70.4 respectively.

▲ Paul van Gass (olive top) and Peru van Staden (yellow top)

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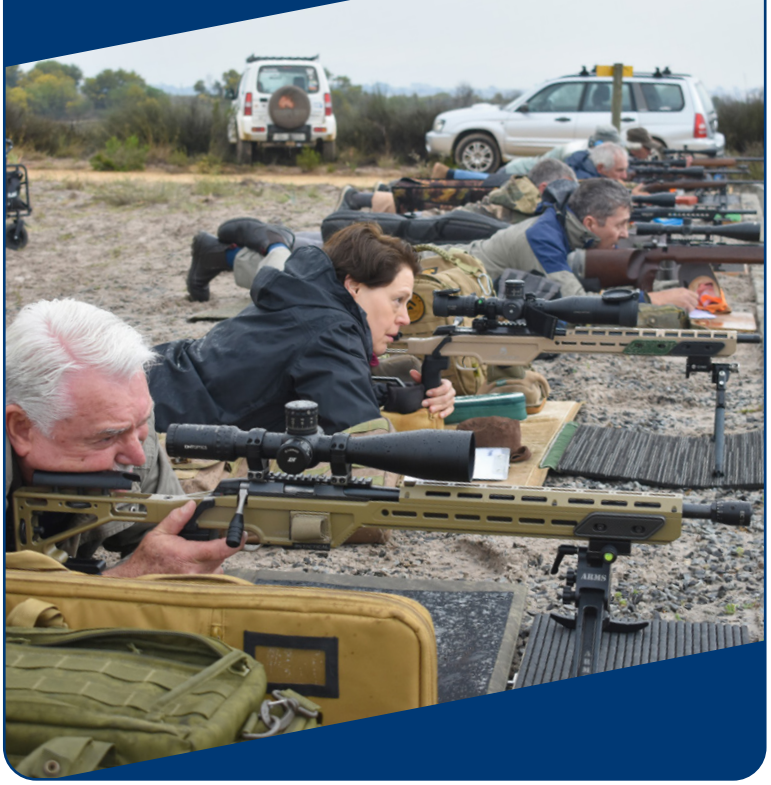
▲ Gustav Kuhn

▲ Carel Taljaard



▲ Arthur Kemp

# A long day in the wind and rain

After a long day in the wind and rain, the competitors were happy to retreat to the clubhouse for the prize-giving. The Short-Range Medal went to Carel, with an aggregate score of 124.17, with Paul only one V-Bull behind.

The Long-Range Medal, based on the ten shots at 200 m and 15 at 300 m, went to Paul, with an outstanding 120.8. This was a truly exceptional performance on any day, but particularly so given the rain and strong winds that prevailed throughout the competition.

## RESULTS

The overall championship result was determined by combining the Short-Range and Long-Range scores:

| Position | Competitor | Score |
|---|---|---|
| First **Gold Medal and 2026 Western Province Open Champion** | **Paul Van Gass** | **244.23** |
| Second **Silver Medal** | **Carel Taljaard** | **243.26** |
| Third **Bronze Medal** | **Gustav Kuhn** | **237.18** |

Congratulations to Paul, the inaugural Western Province .22LR F Class Champion, and to Carel Taljaard and **Gustav Kuhn** on their medal-winning performances. Despite the challenging weather conditions, the competitors all agreed that they thoroughly enjoyed the F Class format and that a great day was had by all.

I am very confident that, with the level of enthusiasm and skill demonstrated by the competitors, .22 F-Class will continue to grow from strength to strength. Whether you are a committed rimfire shooter or a dedicated centre-fire competitor, the additional trigger time that .22 F-Class provides, at a much lower cost than larger calibres, will undoubtedly contribute to the continued growth of the discipline for many years to come.

I hope to see you on the range soon!

## Bisley Shooting in the Western Cape

South African Bisley Union

For anyone interested in shooting Bisley, matches are usually held on both the first and third Saturday of most months at the Good Hope Shooting Range at Atlantis. This includes .308 Target Rifle (A and B classes), F Open, FTR, F Sporting and Black Powder shooting alongside each other.

.22LR Long Range and .303 club competitions are also held once a month.

New members are always welcome, so if you think Bisley-style shooting may be for you, please visit the Western Province Association website at **www.wpbisley.co.za** or Email: **thesecretarywpba@gmail.com**.

If you are not in the Western Cape, visit the SA Bisley website at **www.sabisley.com**

Whatever Bisley discipline you decide to shoot, you will be warmly welcomed on the range!

# Reading the Wind:

## LRSC Training and Fun Shoot Skills Tests at Eendekuil, Western Cape

By André van der Westhuizen

André van der Westhuizen

**On Saturday, 5 September, shooters gathered at the Long Range Shooting Club's (LRSC's) Western Cape range near Eendekuil, just north of Piketberg, for a condensed training course followed by a fun shoot. It was a day designed to make sound long-range principles accessible, put them into practice and remind everyone that, however sophisticated modern rifles and optics may be, the atmosphere still has the final say.**

The Western Cape provided an enthusiastic lesson. The wind gusted 20 km/h to 30 km/h across the range, ensuring holding a rifle steady and pressing a trigger was no simple exercise. The changing conditions demanded concentration, observation and constant adjustment. They also created exactly the kind of practical learning environment in which good instruction becomes memorable. A calm day can flatter a shooter; a difficult wind reveals whether the fundamentals have truly been understood.

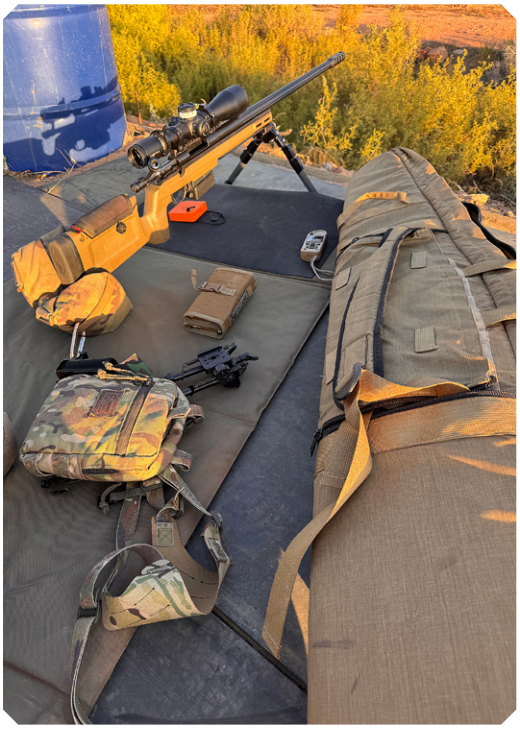
LRSC friendly safety and event day briefing

The event formed part of the LRSC's broader commitment to practical shooting development. Established in 2013, it is the oldest SAPS-accredited long-range shooting club. Although long-range target shooting remains central to its identity, the LRSC caters for a wide range of modern shooting disciplines. These include 4-gun, 3-gun and 2-gun multi-gun events, .22 small-bore precision target shooting, handgun events and pistol calibre carbine, or PCC, competition, together with other opportunities for members to develop their abilities in a structured and responsible environment.

## Multi-gun shooting

That breadth is important. Shooting skills are not isolated from one another. The discipline required to build a stable position behind a precision rifle also benefits a small-bore competitor. Efficient firearm handling, stage planning and safe movement in multi-gun shooting improve a competitor's awareness and composure. PCC shooting adds speed and economy, while long-range shooting teaches patience, careful observation and respect for small variables. By supporting several disciplines, the LRSC gives shooters room to develop into more versatile and thoughtful sportsmen and women.

▲ André van der Westhuizen



◄ 6.5 Creedmoor rifle

▲ Instructor Bernard Cilliers assisting Sohné Louw. 6 mm Dasher rifle

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▲ Instructor Bernard Cilliers explaining to Bryn Collier how the Kestrel 5700 Elite functions.

▲ Sohné Louw taking aim at the 380 m target.

## Connecting theory on the range

The condensed course near Eendekuil reflected that development-minded approach. Rather than treating long-range shooting as a mysterious pursuit dependent upon expensive equipment, structured training breaks the task into understandable parts. A shooter must know the rifle and ammunition, establish a reliable zero, use the optic correctly, build a stable position, manage the trigger squeeze and follow through. Once these fundamentals are repeatable, attention can turn to external ballistics and, most critically, the wind.

Training offered through the LRSC and ABC Lab (the training unit for SA Wingshooters and LRSC) is intended to help shooters connect theory with what happens on the range. Ballistic data, velocity, bullet characteristics and scope adjustments matter, but figures acquire meaning only when a shooter sees their effect on steel or paper at distance. Condensed instruction is particularly useful for introducing the complete process: prepare the equipment, confirm the data, observe the conditions, make a reasoned correction, fire the shot and assess the result.

## Asking the right questions prevents random corrections

▲ Sohné Louw made light work of the midrange targets using Bernard Cilliers 6 mm Dasher.

This is where coaching adds enormous value. A new long-range shooter may see only a miss. An experienced instructor looks at the entire shot process and helps identify the probable cause. Was the position unstable? Was the rifle canted? Was the elevation correct? Did the shooter disturb the rifle while pressing the trigger? Did the wind change between observation and firing? Learning to ask the right questions prevents random corrections and builds a method that can be repeated independently.

## Wind is critical

On this particular Saturday, the wind ensured that observation was central to every decision. Wind is the most important environmental factor in long-range shooting because it acts on the bullet throughout its flight. Gravity is predictable and can be accounted for with reliable range and ballistic information. Wind is far less accommodating. It can differ in strength and direction between the firing point and the target, change during the bullet's flight, and vary from one shot to the next. All wind matters, from the muzzle to the target.

A common early mistake is to judge the wind only where the shooter is lying. The breeze felt on one's face may not represent conditions halfway downrange or near the target. Terrain can channel, shelter or disturb airflow. Ridges, vegetation and open patches may create several distinct wind zones. The effective wind acting on the bullet is therefore a combined picture, not a single convenient reading. This is exactly what makes our range in the Western Cape challenging.

## Gathering clues

Shooters learn to gather clues from every available source. Wind flags are valuable where provided, but natural indicators are equally important. Moving grass, leaves, dust and mirage can reveal both direction and relative strength. Mirage viewed through a spotting scope can be particularly informative, although reading it accurately requires experience. The angle and speed of its apparent flow help the observer form an estimate, while sudden changes warn that an earlier correction may no longer be suitable.

The 20 km/h to 30 km/h gusts at the LRSC range made this process challenging and entertaining. A difference of 10 km/h is significant at distance, and a correction that produces a centre hit during a lull may result in a wide impact at the next gust. Shooters had to recognise patterns, decide whether to fire immediately, or wait and learn from the placement of each shot. The conditions transformed the range into a living classroom.

# Friendly competition gives training purpose.

▲ Rudi Krüger loading his magazine while Bryn Collier looks on.

▲ L to R: Rudi Krüger, Jeffrey Morey

▲ Daniel Badenhorst from EuroOptic Africa, Stellenbosch.

## Concluding fun shoot

The fun-shoot format was therefore an ideal conclusion to the course. Friendly competition gives training purpose without removing the pleasure that attracts people to the sport. One of our main aims at SA Wingshooters Association (the second oldest SAPS accredited hunting and sport shooting association in South Africa) is to interact with members and to ensure they have fun. Competition is last in the queue.

Events of this kind also serve an important social function. Clubs thrive when knowledge is shared, newcomers are welcomed and safe habits are reinforced by the group. A range day brings together shooters with different rifles, backgrounds and levels of experience, yet the challenge is common to all. Conversations about wind calls, positions, ammunition and impacts continue between shooters and often become as valuable as formal instruction.

For the SA Wingshooters Association, the LRSC's work provides members with an additional path for responsible participation in the shooting sports. Wingshooters already understand that field conditions rarely match neat predictions. Wind influences birds, shot patterns and the judgement required in the field; long-range target shooting examines that same moving atmosphere in a measured environment. The disciplines differ, but both reward preparation, restraint and respect for one's limitations.

The September training day succeeded precisely because the weather refused to make it easy. Participants were given more than a pleasant morning of firing from a stable line. The morning was rounded off by a free Karoo lamb chop and boerewors braai at the pistol range. Above all, the occasion proved that training and good fellowship remain among the strongest foundations of sustainable shooting sport. A huge thank you to **Daniel Badenhorst** of EuroOptic Africa for enjoying the day with us.

▲ A successful morning rounded off with a Karoo lamb chop and boerewors braai

▲ L to R: Bernard Cilliers (ABC Lab Instructor for LRSC and SA Wingshooters Executive Committee), André van der Westhuizen (ABC Lab Instructor for LRSC and SA Wingshooters), Mark Schuurmans (LRSC & SA Wingshooters member and National Council member), Emile Tredoux (Farm owner/Range owner and member of SA Wingshooters and LRSC)

▲ Front: Maxine Wright

For shooters interested in precision rifle shooting, small-bore shooting, PCC or multi-gun competition, the LRSC offers an association in which skills can be developed safely and in a fun environment. Its combination of instruction and enjoyable shooting helps remove barriers for newcomers while giving experienced members worthwhile challenges. Further information about the club, its disciplines and future activities is available at **www.longrangeclub.com.**

## Contact

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# SA Gunowners' Association (SAGA) Review:

# Firearm Control in Africa

## What the assessment of selected African licensing systems can tell South Africa about risk and regulatory design

## Issued by the SAGA Board of Trustees

**South Africa's civilian-firearm regime is highly restrictive and heavily regulated. However, that does not necessarily mean it is well designed or efficiently administered.**

A comparison of selected African firearm-control systems shows why a simple '*permissive versus strict*' scale can obscure the policy question that matters most: how effectively does a system restrict access by dangerous or disqualified people, control illicit firearms and regulate competent, lawful owners without consuming scarce policing capacity in repetitive administration?

### Synopsis

South Africa is not necessarily the most restrictive civilian-firearm regime in Africa. Some jurisdictions impose tighter access limits, annual renewal cycles, quotas or wider official discretion. What distinguishes South Africa is its combination of competency certification, purpose-based motivation, category-specific rules, a separate application for each firearm, recurring renewal, secure-storage requirements and unusually high administrative volume. More paperwork does not, by itself, establish more effective control.

## Asking the Right Questions

Instead of asking only, *'How strict is the law?,'* a meaningful comparison should separate four questions:

1. **Access:** How difficult is it for an otherwise suitable civilian to qualify?
2. **Discretion:** How much power does an official retain to refuse an applicant who meets the stated criteria?
3. **Administration:** How often are the same person and firearm reprocessed, renewed or re-vetted?
4. **Enforcement:** Does the state control illicit trafficking, diversion, theft and unlawful use?

## What African Laws Actually Show

- **South Africa is criteria-based but materially discretionary.** The Firearms Control Act requires a separate application for each firearm and repeatedly provides that the Registrar ***'may issue'*** a licence. For self-defence, Section 13 requires the applicant to show a need for a firearm that cannot be satisfied by means other than possession of a firearm.

- **Namibia offers a useful contrast.** The Inspector-General may issue a licence for the arm described, but an ordinary possession licence remains valid until transfer, disqualification, forfeiture or another statutory terminating event. The Act does not impose a routine renewal cycle for that licence.

- **Botswana controls civilian acquisition through quota and raffle mechanisms.** Government guidance states that firearm licences are renewed every five years. It also limits a resident firearm owner to importing one hundred rounds of ammunition per year, while the quantity that may be possessed at any one time is governed separately by the endorsement on the firearm registration certificate.

- **Zimbabwe provides a useful three-year comparator. A separate firearm certificate is required for each firearm.** It is valid for three years and may be renewed for further three-year period. The certificate also specifies the quantities of ammunition authorised for purchase and possession.

- **Kenya combines a statutory good-reason and public-safety test with annual renewal.** A certificate may identify more than one firearm and ***may be granted*** only if the licensing authority is satisfied that the applicant has good reason and can possess, use and carry the firearm or ammunition without danger to public safety or the peace.

- **Rwanda is restrictive in a different way.** Law No. 56/2018 requires police lice**n**sing, written justification, integrity, a minimum age of twenty-one, medical certification and police-certified handling skills. The licensing authority ***may refuse*** an application, and one firearm is the default limit unless specific authority is granted for more**.**

- **Uganda places wide discretion in the licensing authority.** The Act requires reasonable cause, competence, a minimum age of twenty-five, sound mind, safe custody and fit-and-proper status, while permitting ***refusal without reason.*** A certificate expires on 31 December in the year of issue and may be renewed for one year.

- **Sierra Leone uses detailed statutory screening.** The 2023 Act addresses age, criminal and family-violence history, medical fitness, competency training, secure storage, police and national-security clearance, ***written reasons for refusal*** and a right of appeal to the High Court. An ordinary licence is valid for 12 months.

> ***Note:*** *Annexure A (on page 37) compares selected statutory systems to illustrate different regulatory designs. It is* ***not*** *a ranking of every African jurisdiction, and legislation should not be confused with the quality or consistency of administration in practice.*

## Five Findings from the African Comparison

### 1. South Africa is highly regulated but not uniquely restrictive

Across the selected jurisdictions, civilian access ranges from highly discretionary to quota-controlled and criteria-based. The comparison does not support a categorical claim that South Africa has *"Africa's strictest gun law."* It does show that South Africa combines demanding statutory controls with an unusually onerous firearm-by-firearm administrative burden.

### 2. Administrative burden is a policy choice

Namibia is the clearest regional contrast. It requires a licence to possess a firearm and excludes disqualified people, yet the ordinary possession licence remains valid until a defined event ends it. South Africa renews firearm licences on fixed cycles even where the owner remains competent and the firearm has not changed. Periodic risk review may be legitimate, but recurring full renewal for each firearm is a policy choice, not an inevitable feature of effective control.

### 3. Discretion can be stricter than paperwork

Uganda and Eswatini give licensing authorities broad discretion. Botswana restricts ordinary acquisition through quotas and a raffle process. Rwanda limits a civilian to one firearm unless more are specifically authorised. These systems may restrict access more severely than South Africa without reproducing South Africa's administrative architecture.

### 4. Registration need not repeat the full owner-vetting process

Several African systems distinguish, in different ways, between the suitability of the person and the recording of firearms held. Zambia is instructive: its legislation separates the firearm certificate from the firearm licence and allows an existing licence to be varied to add further firearms. The mechanics differ, but verifying the person and recording the firearm need not be collapsed into one repetitive process.

### 5. Regional instruments address illicit firearms as well as lawful possession

The SADC Protocol on the Control of Firearms, Ammunition and Other Related Materials covers civilian and state possessions, but in principle it is equally concerned with illicit manufacture and trafficking, marking, record-keeping, operational capacity, information exchange and regional cooperation.

***Key point:*** *A regional control strategy is incomplete if it treats civilian licensing as the whole problem while neglecting illicit supply, diversion and theft.*

## Why Regulatory Design Matters

This legal comparison does not establish that fewer controls produce less crime, or that one regulatory model is inherently safer than another.

It supports a narrower conclusion: comparable public-safety objectives can be pursued through *different* regulatory designs. South Africa could retain competency requirements, background screening, secure storage, traceability and disqualification powers while removing duplication that does not materially improve risk control.

## South Africa's High Volume and Repetitive Administration

The scale of the Central Firearms Register turns administrative design into a policing-resource and capacity issue.

Periodic review has a legitimate purpose because a person's risk profile can change. The question is whether that requires a full firearm-by-firearm renewal process, or whether person-based risk review, combined with an accurate firearm register, could achieve the same regulatory purpose with less duplication. Every additional administrative touchpoint carries cost and creates another opportunity for delay or error.

In 2024/25 SAPS reported the receipt of **427 435 firearm-related applications:**

- 192 079 (45%): Competency applications,
- 166,603 (39%): New firearm-licence applications and
- 55,936 (13%): Renewal applications; and
- 12,817 (3%): Comprised temporary and import/export authorizations.

**At that scale, every unnecessary administrative touchpoint competes for finite Central Firearms Registry (CFR) and policing capacity that could be directed elsewhere.**

## A Smarter South African Regulatory Architecture

SAGA advocates a more effective, efficient and risk-based system that would:

- retain meaningful competency, background and disqualification checks;
- retain secure-storage requirements and reliable firearm traceability;
- move towards person-based eligibility, with each firearm registered against the holder's licence rather than requiring a largely repetitive owner-focused process for every firearm;
- replace repetitive manual renewals, where no material circumstances have changed, with periodic risk reviews and secure digital declarations by compliant firearm owners;
- strengthen prompt risk intervention through the FCA's existing declaration-of-unfitness mechanisms, supported by due process and clear, objective statutory triggers; and
- fully digitise the CFR and redirect enforcement capacity towards illicit firearms, theft and diversion, cross-border trafficking, criminal syndicates and violent crime.

Person-based eligibility would not mean firearm deregistration. Every firearm would remain individually recorded against its lawful holder in the central register, preserving accountability and traceability.

## A Rational Test for Future Firearms Amendments

Each proposed amendment should be evaluated against an evidence-based framework:

- ✓ Does it identify a demonstrated risk and show how it will materially reduce that risk?
- ✓ Does it improve traceability or public safety?
- ✓ Does it avoid or reduce unnecessary duplication?
- ✓ Does it strengthen enforcement against illicit supply?

If a proposal merely adds another form, renewal cycle, quantity limit or discretionary hurdle without showing why existing controls are insufficient and how the measure will reduce risk, it adds restriction without demonstrating better control.

***Key point:*** *This test is required immediately: Parliament's May 2026 budget report records an intention to introduce a Firearms Control Amendment Bill by the end of the 2026/27 financial year.*

## Conclusion

Africa does not offer a single firearm-control model. The selected jurisdictions illustrate quota-controlled acquisition; one-, three-, five- and ten-year licence or certificate cycles; licences without routine expiry; broad official discretion; good-reason tests; firearm limits; competency requirements and central registers.

**That diversity demonstrates why regulatory design matters.**

A State can apply demanding eligibility standards without repeatedly treating a known, compliant owner as though every application starts from zero.

**SAGA's position is clear: establish the person's eligibility, register every firearm, retain meaningful accountability, and direct policing resources towards the greatest threats to public safety - illicit firearms and violent criminals.**

***Scoping Note:*** *This is a selected comparison of statutory regulatory designs. It is neither a ranking of every African state nor a comparison of crime outcomes. Terms such as licence, certificate and permit follow the legislation of each jurisdiction and should not be assumed to be equivalent. Subsidiary rules, later amendments and administrative practice may differ by jurisdiction.*

**SAGA a trusted voice in the firearms sector for over four decades**

**Drafted by Shaun Lyle, Trustee**

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**Verification and Sources**

- *Firearms Control Act 60 of 2000, Firearms Control Regulations, SAPS Annual Report 2024/25 and Parliament's CSPS 2026/27 Budget Report;*
- *Namibia - Arms and Ammunition Act 7 of 1996;*
- *Botswana - Arms and Ammunition Act 19 of 2018, as amended in 2023; applicable regulations; and Botswana Government guidance on licence renewal, the acquisition raffle and resident ammunition imports;*
- *Zimbabwe - Firearms Act [Chapter 10:09], including section 5; Zambia - Firearms Act 45 of 1969;*
- *Eswatini - Arms and Ammunition Act 24 of 1964;*
- *Kenya - Firearms Act (Cap. 114);*
- *Uganda - Firearms Act, Chapter 320;*
- *Rwanda - Law No. 56/2018 Relating to Arms;*
- *Sierra Leone - Commission on Arms and Ammunitions Act 2023;*
- *Regional - SADC Protocol on the Control of Firearms, Ammunition and Other Related Materials (2001).*

# ANNEXURE A | SELECTED AFRICAN FIREARM-CONTROL SYSTEMS

| Country | Control profile | Licence architecture | Renewal | Key restriction / feature | RSA comparison |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **South Africa** | High-control, category-based | Separate application for each firearm; competency certificate; purpose-based motivation; prescribed safe storage | 5 years (s13 self-defence); 10 years (s15/s16) | Combined four-firearm limit under sections 13 and 15; 200-cartridge limit unless an exception applies | High application volume and repeated firearm-by-firearm administration |
| **Namibia** | Licensed; official discretion | Licence to possess each firearm; Inspector-General may issue | No routine expiry; valid until a specified terminating event | Under-18 and disqualified persons excluded; certain arms restricted or prohibited | Shows that individual firearm control does not require recurring firearm-licence renewal. |
| **Botswana** | Quota-controlled; restrictive acquisition | Acquisition permit / registration / firearm licence; ordinary acquisition uses quota and raffle mechanisms | Five years | Quota-limited acquisition; resident-import guidance limits imports to 100 rounds yearly; the registration certificate separately caps ammunition held | Access can be restricted through quota and selection rather than repeated licensing alone |
| **Zimbabwe** | Good-reason / public-safety test | Separate firearm certificate required for each firearm | 3 years | Certificate specifies ammunition quantities; automatic firearms and silencers are specially restricted | A traditional per-firearm certificate model with a shorter renewal cycle |
| **Zambia** | Two-stage, discretionary certificate model | Firearm certificate + firearm licence; existing licence may be varied to add further firearms | 3 years | Ammunition purchase and holding quantities are stated on the licence | Illustrates a distinction between certification and the licence record for firearms held |
| **Eswatini** | Highly discretionary | Regional recommendation, licensing-officer decision and firearm registration | Annual licence | Renewal requires the firearm registration certificate and may involve inspection or identification verification | More discretionary and more frequent renewal than South Africa, but on a much smaller scale |
| **Kenya** | Good-reason / public-safety test | Firearm certificate; certificate may identify multiple firearms | 1 year | Secure custody; suitability review; ammunition quantities authorised | Frequent renewal does not necessarily require a separate certificate for every firearm |
| **Uganda** | Highly discretionary | Certificate identifies the firearm; Chief Licensing Officer controls issue | Annual; expires 31 December in year of issue and is renewable for one year | Age 25; reasonable cause; competence; sound mind; safe custody; fit-and-proper test; refusal may be without reasons | Shows how broad discretion may restrict access independently of administrative volume |
| **Rwanda** | Highly restrictive / discretionary | Police licence to possess and carry | Annual fee; no directly comparable five- or ten-year cycle | One firearm by default; justification; medical fitness; police handling-skills certificate | Restrictive access and quantity control within a different regulatory design |
| **Sierra Leone** | Strict, criteria-heavy | Commissioner-issued licence; national register | 12 months | Over 21; competency; medical fitness; secure storage; police and security vetting; High Court appeal | Shows that strict screening can coexist with written reasons and judicial appeal |

***Table Note****: "Renewal" refers to the ordinary civilian licence or certificate cycle compared here. Dealer, business, specialist and temporary permissions may differ.*

***Important:*** *"More restrictive" and "more administratively burdensome" are not synonyms. Botswana and Rwanda may impose more severe barriers to civilian acquisition, while South Africa may still impose more repetitive administration on an owner who has already been vetted and remains compliant.*

# EARMOR M23T AI Earbuds

By Aziza Scheidereiter

**Most of us who enjoy time at the range also tend to be absolute gadget magpies. Besides the smell of gun powder, what is more exciting than adding new items to the range bag?**

M23T AI Yellow

Technology has come a long way in terms of in-ear hearing protection. What was mostly inaccessible to the majority is now available at a similar price point to electronic mid-range over-ear hearing protection.

The predecessor to the M23T AI earbuds was most certainly a viable and popular option but it lacked some refining features, with the main complaint being the size of the devices. The M20 model was effective and affordable but uncomfortable for some.

## The latest iteration delivers

Enter the latest iteration. EARMOR most certainly delivers, not only on reliable products, but also with their commitment to well-presented and neat packaging, as well as informative and simple marketing.

Unboxing the M23T AI earbuds makes it feel as if one has spent one's well-earned money on something worthwhile. On opening the box, one is presented with the sturdy EARMOR charging case showcasing the colour accents of the set and the earbuds themselves.

## Different size ear tips

Underneath the plastic insert is the easy-to-understand instruction manual with its four concise and descriptive English pages, a USB-C charging cable as well as a plastic hard case containing different size ear tips in both memory foam and silicone options.

It is evident that careful thought and design went into both the presentation and packaging of the items, making it easy to repack the box without frustration and having important items such as the ear tips in a convenient case for future use.

## EARMOR Android or Apple app

The Earmor M23T AI earbuds can be used without a cellphone app for hearing protection, impulse suppression, environmental listening and Bluetooth audio features. However, to use the earbuds to their full potential, the official EARMOR Android or Apple app should be downloaded.

At the time of writing, the Android version still lacked some exciting features but was user-friendly and allowed essentials such as audio settings, volume balancing, decibel meter, firmware updates, AI assistant features (though this still links to your existing AI assistant set up on your cellphone) as well as the real-time language translation. Overall, the Android experience is user-friendly and intuitive.

The main feature not yet present for Android users, but apparently in the pipeline, is the shot timer feature that Apple users can already enjoy. The Apple version is also slightly more refined and polished. To break down all the features of the earbuds:

**Hearing Protection and Impulse Suppression:** Impulse noise suppression is activated in less than 1 millisecond once the sound exceeds 82 dB. The ear buds boast a Noise Reduction Rating (NRR) of 25 dB / Single Number Rating (SNR) of 31.

**Environmental Settings:** In the Sound Pick Up Mode, the user is able to choose between Low, Medium or High ambient sounds or to switch off the Ambient mode entirely, which comes in handy if one needs to double up the ear plugs as noise-cancelling ear buds in noisy environments. The Ambient sound modes still make normal conversation possible without irritation.

**App Controls and AI Translation:** Accessing the App controls is simple and intuitive for users and allows various controls to be adjusted. The real-time AI translation would come in handy for international competitors. The App also allows for audio balancing, as the earbuds have no designated Left or Right bud. Users are easily able to adjust once the buds are placed in the ear, without having to switch sides.

**Additional App Features:** The App allows real-time monitoring of environmental noise levels to aid the user in choosing the applicable mode as well as a Shot Timer, currently only available to Apple users, allowing easy and hands-free access to a shot timer.

## Comfortable but firm fit

Android users will hopefully soon be able to enjoy the shot timer feature. Reading the manual is a must as the light display is tricky to comprehend without this vital information. The ear tips require some fiddling, but once the correct size and material preference is determined, they are a comfortable but firm fit.

While the earbuds are small, they definitely punch above their weight. The most welcome and noticeable upgrade is most certainly the size of the units themselves. The earbuds are now comfortable enough to wear for long periods of time, which is a bonus for those who get easily frustrated with the pressure of over-ear hearing protection pressing their glasses into their temples.

In-ear hearing buds have a multitude of advantages in terms of comfort (and space in your range bag!) There is also no need to worry about weather conditions or some tactical sweat, as the M23T AI's carry an IPX5 water resistance rating. When not in use, the new case design holds the earbuds firmly in place and ensures constant contact with the case for charging.

▲ M23T AI Yellow Set

## Technical Specifications

**Bluetooth Version**: Bluetooth® 6.0

**Audio Processor**: Next-Gen Dual-Core 32-Bit CPU

**Speaker**: 6 mm High-Fidelity Dynamic Driver

**Microphones**: 4 x Omnidirectional (360° HRTF) + 2 x ENC (calls)

**Water Resistance**: IPX5

**Hearing Protection**: NRR 25 dB / SNR 31 dB

**Impulse Suppression**: <1ms (activates above 82 dB)

**Battery Capacity**: 45 mAh x 2 / Case: 400 mAh

**Battery Life**: Up to 24 h (tactical) / 10 h (music) / 8 h (mixed)

**Weight**: 4.2 g x 2 / Charging Case (59 g)

**Colours currently available in South Africa**: Tactical Black, Foliage Green, Coyote Brown, EARMOR Yellow, Specter Purple, Assault Orange

## Contact

CHS Guns & Ammunition
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Website: www.chsguns.co.za

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# REDI for the Field

## Havalon REDI Everyday Carry Knife

▲ Havalon REDI Everyday Carry Knife

**A dependable knife is one of those pieces of equipment that quickly earns a permanent place in a range bag, hunting pack or pocket. From everyday cutting tasks to work around camp and in the field, versatility matters, and that is exactly what sets the Havalon REDI apart.**

Developed as Havalon's first dedicated everyday carry knife, the REDI takes the brand's well-known replaceable-blade concept and adapts it for longer-term, more demanding use. Instead of the ultra-fine disposable blades associated with Havalon's traditional hunting knives, the REDI uses heavier-duty AUS-8 stainless-steel drop-point blades designed to withstand extended use and, importantly, to be resharpened.

▲ Havalon REDI AUS-8 stainless steel

▲ Havalon REDI - fully ambidextrous

## Two interchangeable drop-point blades

Each REDI is supplied with two interchangeable drop-point blades, one with a plain edge and the other partially serrated. This gives the user the flexibility to switch between a clean slicing edge and the additional cutting ability of a serrated section, depending on the job at hand. A blade holder is included for storing the spare blade when it is not in use.

At the centre of the design is Havalon's patented REDI Lock system. Changing blades is intentionally straightforward. Just press the release, slide the fitment and the blade can be removed and replaced. It gives the user the option of changing blade styles without carrying an entirely separate knife.

## Spring-assisted opening

The REDI also introduced another first for Havalon with its spring-assisted opening. This allows the blade to be deployed smoothly with one hand, an especially useful feature when working outdoors or when the other hand is occupied.

The design is also fully ambidextrous, with a movable pocket clip that can be repositioned for either left- or right-handed carry. Its reinforced nylon handle is shaped and textured to provide a secure grip, while the folding format keeps the knife compact enough for everyday carry. A liner-lock adds rigidity when the blade is deployed.

## Hunting and outdoor use

For hunters and outdoor users, the REDI bridges an interesting gap. It offers the convenience of a replaceable-blade system without treating the blade as something that needs to be discarded after limited use. When an edge eventually becomes worn, it can be sharpened or the entire blade can simply be swapped out.

For shooters, hunters and outdoor enthusiasts looking for a compact everyday knife with a different approach to versatility, the Havalon REDI combines traditional folding-knife practicality with one of the features that made Havalon famous: the ability to change your blade when the situation demands it.

## At a Glance

**Blade Steel:** AUS-8 stainless steel

**Blade Style:** Drop point

**Included Blades:** Two, plain edge and partially serrated

**Blade System:** Patented REDI Lock replaceable system

**Opening:** Spring-assisted, one-handed operation

**Carry:** Repositionable pocket clip

**Handedness:** Fully ambidextrous

**Additional Accessories:** Blade holder and T5 Torx bit

HAVALON KNIVES

**Imported and distributed in South Africa by Ultranexus, and available from leading retailers.**

ULTRANEXUS

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▲ Acebeam L16 2.0 tactical flashlight

# Acebeam L16 2.0 Tactical Flashlight

**A good tactical flashlight must offer more than raw brightness. It should provide usable reach, fast access to the right output, dependable construction and enough versatility to handle everything from range use and hunting to security, outdoor work and emergency situations.**

The Acebeam L16 2.0 Tactical Flashlight has been designed around exactly that combination. Powered by a Luminus SFT-40 HI LED, it produces a maximum output of 2 100 lumens with a rated beam distance of up to 670 m. That long-range performance makes it particularly useful when identifying objects or scanning terrain well beyond the immediate area around the user.

## Six primary levels

Rather than relying on one extremely bright setting, the L16 2.0 provides a useful range of outputs. Its six primary levels extend from a 1-lumen Moonlight mode all the way to Turbo, with intermediate settings of 70, 200, 450 and 1 000 lumens. This gives the user much greater control over battery consumption and light output depending on the task. At its lowest setting, maximum runtime is rated at up to 250 hours.

Control is handled through a dual-switch system. The side switch provides access to the different brightness settings, while the tactical tail switch allows immediate access to Turbo, including momentary activation. Strobe can also be accessed through the side controls when required. The result is a system that works for both everyday illumination and situations where maximum output needs to be available immediately.

## Redesigned tail-cap system

Another practical improvement over the original L16 is the redesigned tail-cap system. The L16 2.0 incorporates a USB-C charging port directly into the tail cap and supports an optional remote pressure switch that plugs into the same interface without requiring the tail cap to be replaced. The light can also operate while charging, adding flexibility during prolonged use.

Power comes from an included 21700 5 000 mAh rechargeable Li-ion battery for its high-output modes while keeping the flashlight compact enough for regular carry. Durability is equally important in a light designed for serious outdoor use.

## Abrasion, corrosion resistant

The L16 2.0 has an AL6061-T6 aluminium body with a HAIII hard-anodised finish for resistance to abrasion and corrosion. It carries an IP68 rating, is rated for submersion to 2 m for up to 30 minutes and has been tested for impacts from up to 1.5 m. At just 153.2 mm long and about 214 g, including the battery, the L16 2.0 offers impressive performance from a relatively compact platform.

For shooters, hunters, security professionals and outdoor users who need both powerful illumination and meaningful distance, the Acebeam L16 2.0 strikes a strong balance. With 2 100 lumens, 670 m of rated throw and straightforward tactical controls, it is designed to put useful light exactly where it is needed.

▲ Acebeam L16 2.0 tactical flashlight

## At a Glance

**Maximum Output:** 2 100 lumens

**Maximum Beam Distance:** 670 m

**Peak Beam Intensity:** 112 225 cd

**LED:** Luminus SFT-40 HI

**Lighting Levels:** Six primary outputs plus Strobe

**Battery:** 21700 5 000 mAh rechargeable Li-ion

**Charging:** USB-C

**Maximum Runtime:** Up to 250 hours

**Water & Dust Resistance:** IP68

**Impact Resistance:** 1.5 m

**Length:** 153.2 mm

**Weight:** About 214 g, including battery

ACEBEAM

**Imported and distributed in South Africa by Ultranexus, and available from leading retailers.**

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# MDT DRT Chassis System:
## Lightweight Precision for the Field

▲ MDT DRT Chassis System

A magnesium-based chassis designed to deliver stability, adaptability and night-vision capability without adding unnecessary weight

When a precision rifle is carried deep into the field, every gram matters. The new MDT DRT Chassis System has been designed around that principle, combining a lightweight magnesium chassis with a rigid forend, integrated night-vision bridge and a highly adjustable folding stock.

Developed by Modular Driven Technologies (MDT), the DRT is intended for shooters who need the precision and stability of a chassis system while still having to cover ground before the shot presents itself. The system is designed for the Remington 700 Short Action.

At its core is a skeletonised magnesium chassis and buttstock, bringing the complete chassis, buttstock, NV bridge and carbon-fibre grip to a stated weight of just 3.2 lb (51.2 oz). MDT has combined magnesium with aluminium, titanium and carbon fibre, placing each material where its strength-to-weight characteristics are most useful.

## Built for the night

One of the DRT's defining features is its full-length 20 MOA night-vision (NV) bridge. Designed to accommodate clip-on night-vision equipment while maintaining alignment with the rifle's optic, the rigid bridge and forend are intended to minimise movement under pressure.

For night hunters, maintaining a consistent sight picture and zero is critical. The DRT's NV bridge forms part of a rigid system designed to resist the flex that can contribute to point-of-impact changes when the rifle is supported on a bipod, tripod or shooting bag.

The low bore-axis design also helps reduce the leverage that contributes to muzzle rise. The result is a more stable sight picture through recoil, allowing the shooter to remain behind the optic, observe the impact and reacquire the target quickly.

## Designed to move

A major advantage of the magnesium construction is weight reduction. At 3.2 lb for the main chassis assembly, the DRT is designed to be carried over distance without the additional fatigue associated with a heavier precision-rifle chassis.

That consideration extends to the folding stock. The integrated adjustable friction folder folds the rifle into a more compact package for transport and opens quickly, locking securely into position for shooting. The fold-over bolt design also covers the bolt handle when the stock is folded, further reducing the rifle's footprint.

The length of pull can be adjusted across a 2.25″ range, from 12″ to 14.25″, while the integral cheekpiece provides 1.15″ of height adjustment. Together, these adjustments allow the chassis to be configured around the individual shooter's dimensions, cheek weld and eye position.

## Support where you need it

The DRT is equally focused on the practical demands of shooting from different positions. A multifunction ARCA rail incorporates compatibility with both ARCALOCK and RRS Lock systems, allowing the chassis to interface with compatible tripods and bipods.

The structurally rigid forend is designed to resist flex when pressure is applied through these support systems or when shooting from a bag. An integrated barricade stop provides another useful contact point, allowing the rifle to lock into a support bag without placing pressure on the magazine.

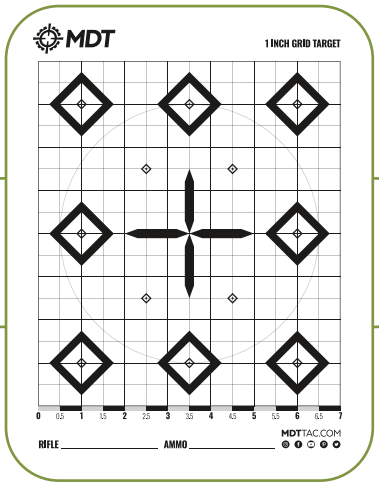
The system also provides M-LOK mounting points along the forend, while an offset Picatinny rail provides a dedicated mounting position for accessories such as laser rangefinders and other Picatinny-compatible equipment. This keeps accessories clear of the ARCA interface and allows different pieces of equipment to occupy their own mounting positions.

## Adjustability and control

MDT has incorporated several additional adjustment features into the DRT. An adjustable magazine latch, using Delrin dowel pins, allows the magazine fit and feed to be fine-tuned, while the lockable magazine latch is designed to keep a loaded magazine securely in place in the field.

▲ Hunt walk in scenario

▲ MDT DRT Chassis System – folded butt stock




The textured adjustable carbon-fibre vertical grip provides additional grip control without adding unnecessary weight. An adjustable M-LOK thumbshelf allows the shooter to position thumb support according to their preferred grip. The combination of these features gives the DRT a high degree of adjustability while retaining the central design philosophy of a lightweight, rigid precision-rifle chassis.

## A multi-material approach

The DRT Chassis System represents MDT's approach to balancing precision-rifle performance with practical field requirements. Magnesium provides the lightweight structural foundation, aluminium is used for the NV bridge and ARCA rail, titanium for selected adjustment and fastening components, and carbon fibre for the grip.

For shooters who need a precision platform that can move from a long walk-in to a supported firing position, while also accommodating night-vision equipment and multiple support systems, the DRT offers a comprehensive chassis solution.

## Specifications

| Specification | Details |
|---|---|
| Material / finish | Magnesium chassis body and buttstock; aluminium NV bridge and ARCA rail; titanium LOP pins, LOP clamp and action screws; carbon-fibre grip |
| Weight | Chassis, buttstock, NV bridge and CF grip: 3.2 lb / 51.2 oz |
| NV bridge spacers | 0.08 lb / 1.3 oz |
| NV bridge | 0.37 lb / 5.92 oz |
| Offset Picatinny rail | 0.2 lb / 3.2 oz |
| Thumbscrew | 0.02 lb / 0.32 oz |
| Length of pull | 12″ (305 mm) to 14.25″ (362 mm) |
| LOP adjustment | 2.25″ |
| Cheekpiece adjustment | 1.15″ |
| Dimensions | 33.7″ x 1.99″ x 7.33″ |
| Maximum barrel diameter | Up to 1.25″ straight contour barrels with included NV Bridge Spacer Kit |
| Forend length | 24.52″; 14.93″ from recoil lug |

MDT

WHYLO DISTRIBUTORS

**MDT DRT Chassis System**
**Action:** Remington 700 Short Action

**Distributed in Southern Africa by:**
Whylo Distributors (Pty) Ltd
Landline: +27 031 584 8088

**Resources:**
MDT Sporting Goods

**Watch:**
MDT DRT Chassis System video
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y_lYtpV_pyM

GLOCK®
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# GLOCK 43 SLIMLINE 9 MM LUGER

## GLOCK Slimline

The smallest GLOCK pistols ever!

- Slim frame with GLOCK single stack magazine
- Built-in beaver tail design

## Size matters - Developed for concealed carry

Designed to be the favoured back up; perfect for everyday concealed carry needs. Slim construction - par excellence: slim slide and slim frame with a single stack magazine.

## Comfortable grip with beaver tail

The grip of the slimline models has a built-in beaver tail design, which allows the shooter to acquire a high and tight grip.

### Safe Action® System
Three safeties disengage sequentially as the trigger is pulled and automatically reengage when the trigger is released.
Same trigger pull for each shot – short trigger reset.

### Barrel profile
The polygonal barrel is easy to clean and its better bullet to barrel fit increases the velocity of the projectile.

### Surface refinement
The surface of the GLOCK slide and barrel is black and non-reflective. All GLOCK metal parts are subject to a surface treatment making them corrosion and salt water resistant.

### Loaded chamber indicator
A visible and palpable indicator is located on the extractor.

### Polymer frame
The durable and lightweight polymer frame absorbs recoil due to the dampening characteristics of the polymer.

### Slide stop lever
A fully functional slide stop lever stops the slide in the rearward position after having fired the last round in the magazine.

### Special grip texture
The slimline RTF was designed to enhance grip traction, without being too aggressive.

### Trigger distance
The trigger distance of the slimline pistols is reduced compared to other GLOCK models. The grip angle is equivalent to the larger pistols in the GLOCK lineup.

### Reversible magazine catch
The magazine catch of the slimline frame is reversible and enlarged towards the rear of the pistol. For left and right handed users.

### Standard GLOCK sights
The dimensions of the standard GLOCK rear sights were reduced to fit the slim slide

### Magazine with extension
A magazine with extension is available for securing the grip and better ergonomics.

### Single stack magazine
The magazine of the GLOCK slimline pistols has a single stack design to reduce its dimensions to a minimum. The metal insert is covered by a polymer coating.

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# IPSC Welcomes Tippmann Arms as Mini Rifle Strategic Partner

The International Practical Shooting Confederation (IPSC) is proud to announce that Tippmann Arms has been named an official IPSC Strategic Partner for Mini Rifle. The partnership agreement was signed on 3 August by IPSC President Vitaly Kryuchin and Tippmann Arms Vice President of Sales Erich Garbers.

Tippmann Arms manufactures premium .22 LR semi-automatic rifles engineered specifically for Mini Rifle competition and affordable, high-volume training. Designed to faithfully replicate the controls, ergonomics, and weight distribution of the AR-15 platform, Tippmann Arms rifles provide competitors with an ideal platform for IPSC Mini Rifle training and competition.

This strategic partnership reflects a shared commitment to advancing the sport of practical shooting by providing IPSC athletes with reliable, high-performance equipment that meets the demands of competition. “We are delighted to welcome Tippmann Arms as an IPSC Mini Rifle Strategic Partner,” said IPSC President **Vitaly Kryuchin**.

## Dedication to premium manufacturing

“Their dedication to manufacturing premium .22 LR semi-automatic rifles based on the AR-15 platform, purpose-built for IPSC Mini Rifle competition and practical shooting sports, aligns perfectly with our mission of supporting and empowering athletes around the world. We thank Tippmann Arms for their continued passion and commitment to the growth of IPSC,” added Vitaly.

“We are honoured to become an IPSC Strategic Partner and look forward to working together to promote and grow the sport of IPSC Mini Rifle worldwide,” said **Erich Garbers**, Vice President of Sales at Tippmann Arms.

## Commitment to supporting competitors

“This partnership represents our commitment to supporting competitors with reliable, high-performance firearms while helping expand participation in one of the fastest-growing disciplines in practical shooting,” stressed Erich. Tippmann Arms would also like to recognise **Barry Giddings**, IPSC Program Manager for Tippmann Arms, whose dedication and leadership were instrumental in developing this strategic partnership.

Barry’s long-standing involvement in the international practical shooting community, combined with his passion for growing IPSC Mini Rifle, helped build the relationships that made this collaboration possible. His efforts continue to strengthen Tippmann Arms’ commitment to competitors, match organisers, and the worldwide IPSC community.

Whether you are an experienced competitor or taking your first steps into IPSC Mini Rifle, IPSC Strategic Partners represent manufacturers committed to delivering equipment designed to perform at the highest levels of competition.

▲ Tippmann Arms M4-22 ELITE FDE Tactical Rifle

## About Tippmann Arms

Tippmann Arms is a leading American manufacturer of premium .22 LR AR-platform firearms designed for competition, training, recreation, and professional use. Headquartered in Fort Wayne, Indiana, Tippmann Arms is committed to delivering innovative, reliable, and precision-built firearms that faithfully replicate the controls, ergonomics, and performance of the AR-15 platform. As an official IPSC Strategic Partner for Mini Rifle, Tippmann Arms is dedicated to supporting the continued growth of practical shooting through innovative products, athlete support, and international partnerships.

For more information, visit **www.tippmannarms.com**.

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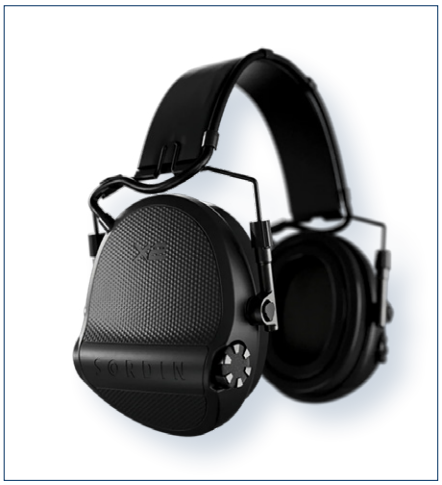
## About the International Practical Shooting Confederation (IPSC)

The International Practical Shooting Confederation (IPSC) is the world’s largest practical shooting organisation, with member regions in more than 100 countries across six continents. IPSC promotes safe, fair, and dynamic practical shooting competitions while fostering marksmanship, sportsmanship, and the continued development of practical shooting disciplines worldwide.

For more information, visit **www.ipsc.org**.



▲ Sordin Supreme X2 - Black

# Sordin Supreme X2

## Delivers Next-Generation Hearing Protection

### Adaptive comfort, natural sound and advanced hearing protection for hunters and shooters

Hearing protection needs to do more than simply reduce noise. For hunters and shooters, being able to hear and identify sounds clearly can be just as important as protecting hearing from damaging noise. The new Sordin Supreme X2 combines advanced noise attenuation with natural sound reproduction, directional hearing and an adaptive fit designed for extended use in demanding outdoor conditions.

At the heart of the Supreme X2 is the SordinHEAR2™ audio system, which offers four selectable audio profiles: Hunter, Focus, Shooter and Ambient Off. These allow users to tailor the balance between hearing and protection to the situation, whether enhancing subtle sounds when hunting, maintaining natural clarity or reducing gain during repeated shots.

The system's high amplification and excellent directionality also allow users to locate the source of sounds accurately without removing their hearing protection.

### A modular approach to comfort

The SordinFLEX™ modular platform allows the Supreme X2 to adapt to individual preferences and equipment. Interchangeable suspension kits include a rugged leather headband, textile headband and low-profile neckband.

Users can also choose between premium GEL and Memory Foam ear cushions, providing all-day comfort while accommodating glasses. Despite its compact design, the Supreme X2 delivers a high level of noise attenuation, with an SNR of 29 and NRR of 23. It is also certified for dual protection when used in earplug mode.

### Built for the outdoors

Designed to withstand demanding conditions, the Supreme X2 features durable, waterproof construction for reliable performance in the field or on the range. A built-in 3.5 mm AUX input provides connectivity for a cellphone or hunting radio, helping users stay connected when required.

Power comes from a single standard AA battery, providing up to 60 hours of continuous use. Alternatively, Sordin Power rechargeable batteries can extend operating time to up to 90 hours.

With its combination of adaptive comfort, directional hearing, advanced attenuation and rugged construction, the Sordin Supreme X2 is designed to provide hunters and shooters with hearing protection that adapts to the demands of the environment without compromising awareness.

▲ Sordin Supreme X2 - Green

WINELANDS PRECISION

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**Email:** info@winelandsprecision.co.za

# CZ 612 TAC

## Pump-Action Shotgun

The CZ 612 TAC is a rugged and dependable pump-action shotgun designed for shooters who demand reliability, versatility, and modern tactical functionality. Combining a proven pump-action system with enhanced ergonomics, it delivers smooth operation and excellent handling in demanding conditions.

Equipped with an 18” chrome-lined barrel, extended magazine capacity, adjustable folding stock, and ghost ring sights, the CZ 612 TAC is ready for home defence, range training, and professional applications alike. Its durable construction, optics-ready design, and user-focused features make it a highly adaptable tactical shotgun platform.

Its reliable, smooth pump-action system is ready for any situation. The 18” chrome-lined barrel with a tactical muzzle brake can handle a wide variety of 12-gauge ammunition, including steel shot and slugs. The barrel is covered by CZ’s lifetime warranty.

### Extended magazine tube

The extended magazine tube offers a solid 6+1-round capacity, making the gun ideal for a wide variety of applications. A folding polymer stock with an adjustable cheek rest and telescopic butt plate allows the shotgun to be easily tailored to the individual shooter.

The comfortable polymer pistol grip, paired with a new folding stock, provides excellent shooting comfort. A long receiver-mounted rail allows for mounting a wide variety of red dots. Shooters who prefer fixed sights can take advantage of the integrated ghost ring sights.

### Technical Specifications

**Units:** CMIN

**Operating mechanism:** Extremely reliable pump-action mechanism

**Rail:** Receiver-mounted rail for red dots and optics

**Shooting comfort:** Comfortable vertical pistol grip

**Stock:** Telescopic stock with three-position LOP adjustment

**Calibre:** 12/76

**Capacity:** 6+1

**Choke:** Multi (3 ks)

**LOP:** 325 mm to 405 mm

**Cheekpiece:** Yes

**Stock:** Polymer

**Overall length:** 1 000 mm

**Weight:** 3.3 kg

**Trigger pull:** 17 N

**Barrel length:** 470 mm

CZ

**Company:** Česká zbrojovka a.s. (CZ)
**Website:** www.czfirearms.com

**Address:** Svatopluka Čecha 1283, Uherský Brod 688 01, Czech Republic, Europe

# Targeting Safety:

## Snake Season Constant Vigilance on Western Cape Ranges

BY THE CAPE REPTILE INSTITUTE (CRI)

CAPE REPTILE INSTITUTE · FIELD GUIDE

### 1 CAPE COBRA — *Naja nivea*

*Cape cobra rearing on the West Coast — note the smooth, shiny scales.*

**EXTREME MEDICAL EMERGENCY**

| LENGTH | EYES | VENOM |
|---|---|---|
| 1.4 – 1.8 m | Round pupils | Neurotoxic |

**ID:** Smooth, shiny body scales and shield-headed scales on top. Colour is highly variable — yellow, gold, brown or near-black — so colour alone never confirms the species. The head looks fairly distinct from the neck, an effect exaggerated by well-developed venom glands.

**Behaviour:** Diurnal. Spreads a long, narrow hood and stands its ground readily, biting without much provocation.

**Bite:** A powerful neurotoxin brings on rapid breathing difficulty and loss of muscle control. Responsible for most snakebite deaths in the province — treatment needs respiratory support and large volumes of antivenom.

### 2 RINKHALS — *Hemachatus haemachatus*

*A rinkhals hooding up — throat bands show clearly in this defensive stance.*

**MEDICAL EMERGENCY**

| LENGTH | SCALES | VENOM |
|---|---|---|
| ~1 m, stocky | Keeled body | Neuro + cyto |

**ID:** A stocky elapid with keeled (ridged) body scales and a head that is not distinct from the body. Colour ranges from banded to uniform grey, with white, orange or yellow bands; the belly is black with distinctive white throat bands. Juveniles are olive-brown to dull black.

**Behaviour:** Spreads a narrow hood like a cobra, but is neither a true cobra nor a true spitting snake — it can eject venom toward an attacker's eyes AND famously shams death by twisting onto its back.

**Bite:** A mixed neurotoxic/cytotoxic venom — dangerous, though less potent than the Cape cobra's.

### 3 BOOMSLANG — *Dispholidus typus*

*A male boomslang perched in the reeds, showing its large eyes and slender build.*

**MEDICAL EMERGENCY — DELAYED ONSET**

| LENGTH | EYES | VENOM |
|---|---|---|
| 1 – 1.5 m (to 2 m) | Large, round-ish | Haemotoxic |

**ID:** Keeled scales and a head fairly distinct from the body. Males are blackish or greyish with yellow-edged scales and yellow bellies; females are brown or olive with pale, creamy bellies.

**Behaviour:** Diurnal and largely arboreal, though it will bask on the ground too. Generally inoffensive, but inflates its neck into a lateral hood when annoyed. Technically "rear-fanged," though its fangs actually sit beneath the eye and a wide gape lets it strike effectively.

**Bite:** A powerful haemotoxin — symptoms can be delayed up to 20 hours, which makes it especially dangerous. Antivenom is held only at major city hospitals in South Africa.

## 4 PUFF ADDER — *Bitis arietans*

*A puff adder basking on rock — chevron markings and a very distinct head are classic tells.*

**MEDICAL EMERGENCY — SLOW RECOVERY**

| LENGTH | EYES | VENOM |
|---|---|---|
| 0.8 – 1.2 m, stout | Small, vertical pupils | Cytotoxic |

**ID:** A large, stout-bodied adder with keeled scales and a head that is very distinct from the body. Colour runs grey-brown to reddish-brown; Western Cape animals tend to be more colourful, with yellow-and-black-edged, forward-facing chevron markings.

**Behaviour:** Diurnal in cooler months, nocturnal in summer. Superb camouflage makes it easy to step on by accident in the veld — it often hisses loudly first as a warning. Large, movable fangs sit at the front of the mouth.

**Bite:** Strikes readily. The cytotoxic venom commonly causes necrosis (tissue death) at the bite site; recovery can be slow.

## 5 MOLE SNAKE — *Pseudaspis cana*

*A coiled mole snake — uniform dark colouring is often mistaken for a Cape cobra.*

**NON-VENOMOUS — PAINFUL BITE**

| LENGTH | EYES | VENOM |
|---|---|---|
| ~1 m (to 2 m in W. Cape) | Small, round pupils | None — constrictor |

**ID:** A large constrictor with smooth body scales, shield-headed scales, and a head that is not distinct from the body. Adults are a uniform shade of brown to black above with a lighter belly; juveniles are boldly marked with zigzags and spots.

**Behaviour:** Active by day and common around farms and vineyards. Its size and dark colouring lead to frequent misidentification as a Cape cobra.

**Bite:** Non-venomous, but a powerful constrictor bite — it will deliver a painful, deep bite if handled or molested.

*"Size and dark colouring make the mole snake the Cape's most common cobra look-alike — check the eyes and hood before you react."*

## QUICK-ID CHEAT SHEET — THE "BIG FIVE"

| SPECIES | HEAD VS. BODY | PUPILS | VENOM TYPE | BITE PRIORITY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cape Cobra** | Fairly distinct | Round | Neurotoxic | Extreme emergency |
| **Rinkhals** | Not distinct | Round | Neuro + cytotoxic | Emergency |
| **Boomslang** | Fairly distinct | Large, round-ish | Haemotoxic | Emergency (delayed) |
| **Puff Adder** | Very distinct | Vertical | Cytotoxic | Emergency |
| **Mole Snake** | Not distinct | Round | None (constrictor) | Not venomous |

CAPE REPTILE INSTITUTE · FIELD GUIDE

# Safety & Emergency Response

What to do before you meet a snake, and what to do in the minutes after a bite.

*Cobus with a Boomslang*

## EMERGENCY CONTACT NUMBERS

| PROVINCIAL AMBULANCE | NETCARE911 | ER24 | POISON INFORMATION HELPLINE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **10177 / 112** | **082 911** | **084 124** | **0861 555 777** |

## Basic Awareness

REDUCE YOUR CHANCE OF A BITE

- Wear closed shoes or boots in the veld — never bare feet or sandals — and use long trousers, preferably jeans.
- Use a light when walking around at night, and stick to roads or cleared paths where possible.
- Watch where you place your feet: step *onto* logs and rocks, not over them, so you can see what's on the other side.
- Leave snakes alone entirely, even ones that look dead — do not approach or handle them.
- Never put an unprotected hand down a hole in the ground; it may be a snake's lair.
- Always carry a charged cell phone when hiking.

## Snakebite Emergency Procedure

FIRST MINUTES AFTER A BITE

### DO

- Alert the nearest hospital or medical centre immediately.
- Expose the bite and flush any excess venom away with a clean, wet cloth.
- Remove constrictive items — rings, watches, shoes — before swelling sets in.
- For a **Cape cobra** bite: apply a pressure bandage, splint the limb, and be ready to give artificial respiration.
- Keep the victim calm and reassured.
- Drive directly to hospital — usually faster than waiting for an ambulance.

### DON'T

- Don't squeeze the wound, and never attempt to cut it.
- Don't apply poultices or herbal "remedies."
- Don't give alcohol or any other stimulant.
- Be aware of the risk of disease transmission (e.g. HIV) if giving mouth-to-mouth.

## First Aid Kit Essentials

CARRY THESE INTO THE FIELD

- Charged cell phone + a card of emergency numbers
- Several 8 cm crepe bandages, plus a square sling bandage
- Latex gloves
- Hygiene kit for artificial mouth-to-mouth respiration
- Band-aids and disinfectant for non-venomous bites

*Accurate identification of the snake responsible is vital. Even "harmless" species — mole snake, skaapsteker, house snake — can inflict a painful, freely-bleeding bite.*

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